

Impact Medium · Difficulty Hard · Misuse risk It fails when clarity curdles into pressure — turning Assert into a demand, Mindful

THE MOVE

Full sequence: Describe -> Express -> Assert -> Reinforce, then stay Mindful, Appear confident, Negotiate. -> Minimum viable move: facts -> impact -> ask or no -> why it helps. -> Four-sentence form: “When X happened, Y was the effect. I ne...

START HERE

Here's what happened, here's how it affects me, here's what I need, and here's why it helps. I can flex on the details, not on the core ask.

SAY THIS

One-breath starters	<i>"Here's what happened, and here's what I need."</i>
Describe — facts with...	<i>"The last two meetings started about fifteen minutes late."</i>
Express — own the impact	<i>"That leaves me rushed and more likely to miss something."</i>
Assert — the ask or the need	<i>"Please send the figures by 2 pm today."</i>
Reinforce — why it helps	<i>"That gives me enough time to do the work properly."</i>
Mindful — stay with the situation	<i>"I hear there are other issues. I'm happy to discuss those after this — right now I need to settle the deadline."</i>

AVOID

- The situation is unsafe and disengaging is wiser.
- The real need is emotional validation before any problem solving.
- You don't yet know what you're actually asking for.

REMEMBER

Keep the Assert short enough to repeat calmly.